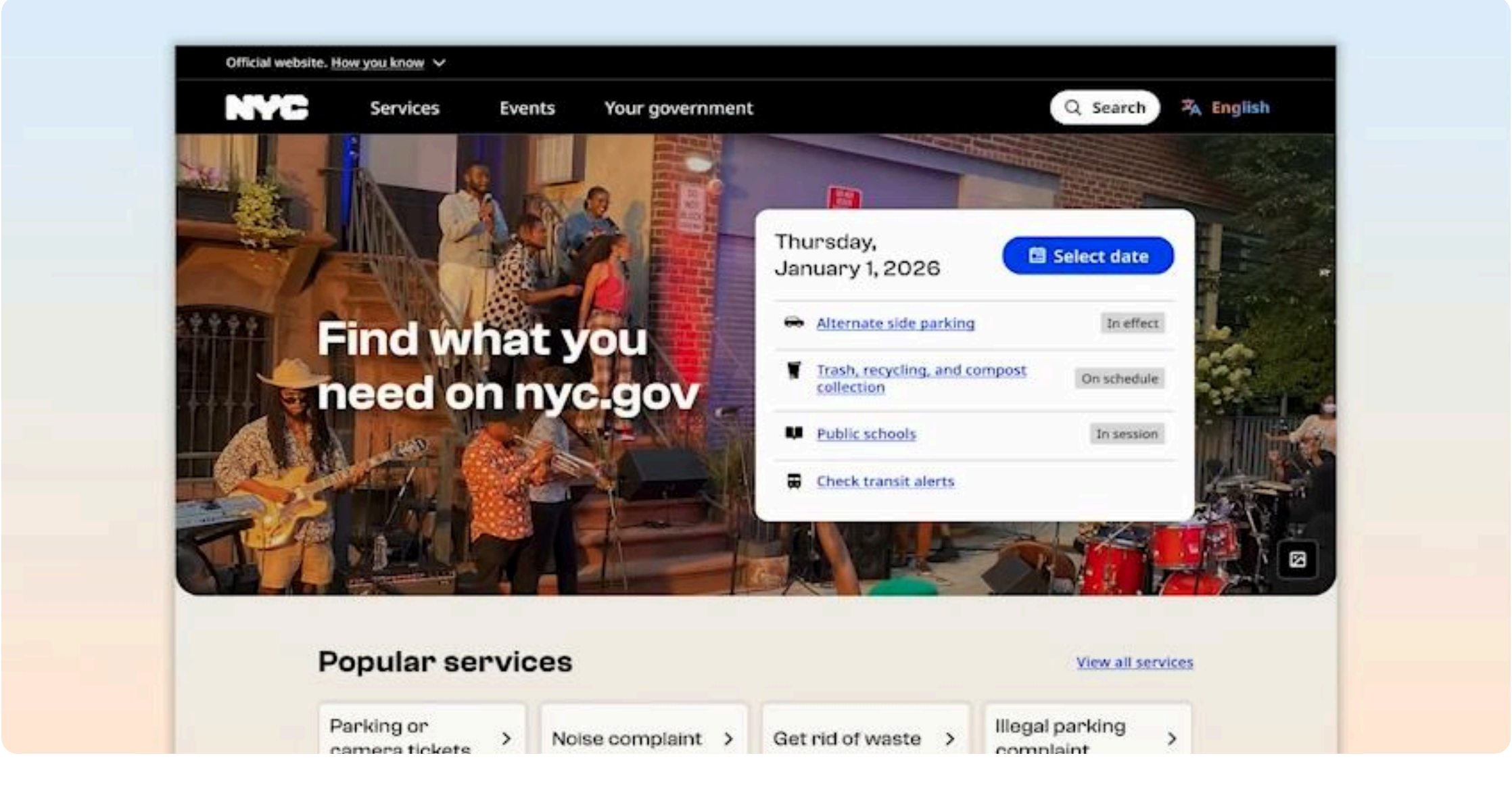

Official website. How you know
NYC
Services
Events
Your government
Search
English
Find what you need on nyc.gov
Thursday, January 1, 2026
Select date
Alternate side parking
In effect
Trash, recycling, and compost collection
On schedule
Public schools
In session
Check transit alerts
Popular services
View all services
Parking or camera tickets
Noise complaint
Get rid of waste
Illegal parking complaint

Helping 1.8 million New Yorkers find what they came for

New Yorkers come to nyc.gov to do something specific: pay a parking ticket, check for school closures, manage their SNAP benefits, and more. Too often, they couldn't find it. The site was organized around government structure instead of what people needed to do, so services sat buried under layers of pages. At times, a task could start users at seven different entry points.

One of our top UX priorities with the redesign was wayfinding: the site architecture, navigation, and layouts that decide whether 1.8 million monthly users can find a service, follow through, and finish it.

We restructured the site around what people actually look for, using research and site analytics to guide every decision. The first step-by-step service page I designed cut 311 call volume by 48%.

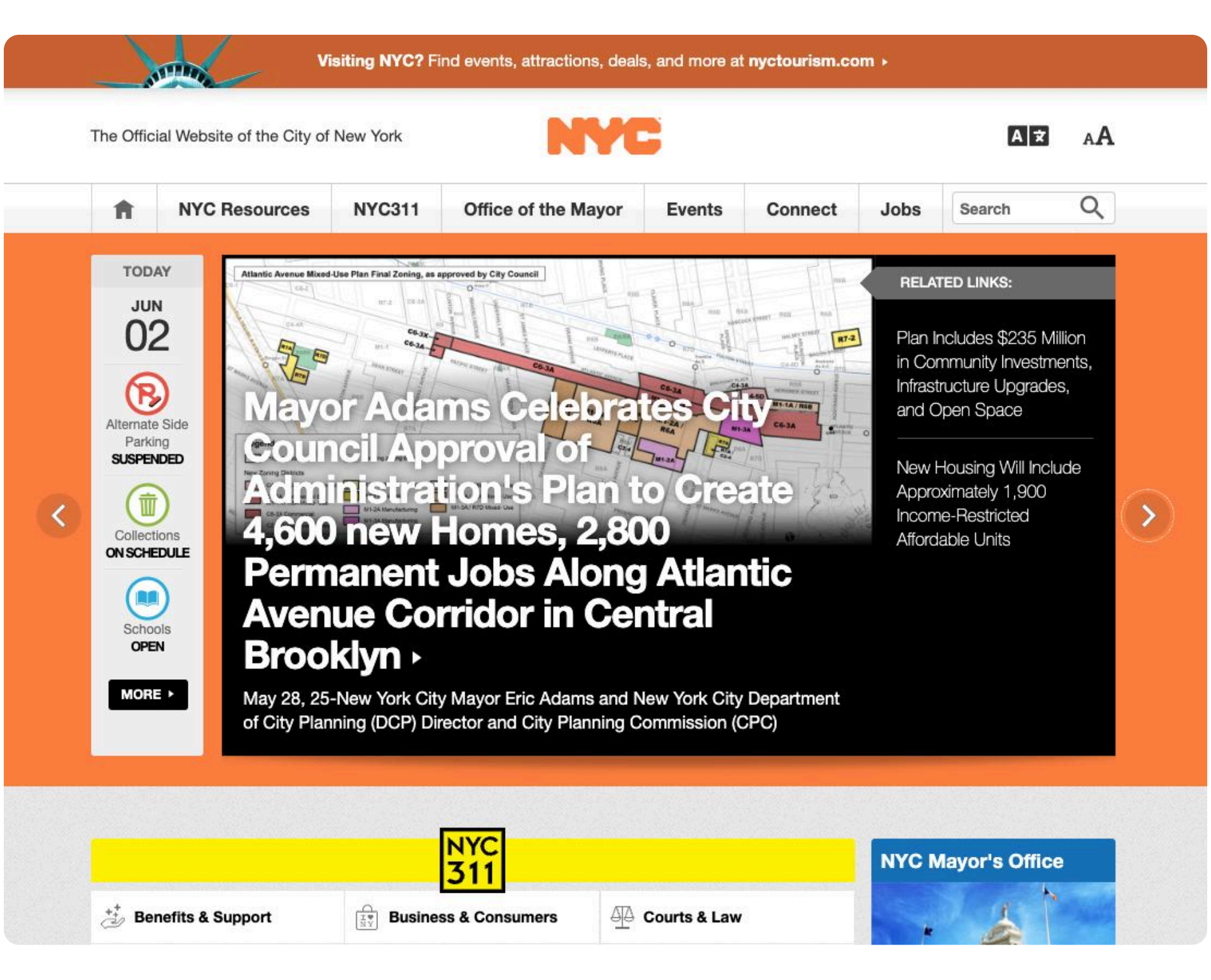
TIMELINE
6 months, 2024

SKILLS
Product strategy,
Product design,
UX research

TEAM
Chief Digital Strategy Officer,
Design Director,
🙋🏻‍♂️ **Product Design Lead**,
Service Design Lead,
Content Strategy Lead,
Engineering Lead
Developer Consultants

PROBLEM

New Yorkers couldn't find what they needed. Those who did still struggled to complete their tasks.


Visiting NYC? Find events, attractions, deals, and more at nyctourism.com ›
The Official Website of the City of New York
NYC
NYC Resources
NYC311
Office of the Mayor
Events
Connect
Jobs
Search
TODAY
JUN
02
Alternate Side Parking
SUSPENDED
Collections
ON SCHEDULE
Schools
OPEN
MORE ›
Mayor Adams Celebrates City Council Approval of Administration's Plan to Create 4,600 new Homes, 2,800 Permanent Jobs Along Atlantic Avenue Corridor in Central Brooklyn ›
RELATED LINKS:
NYC 311
NYC Mayor's Office
Benefits & Support
Business & Consumers
Courts & Law

May 28, 25-New York City Mayor Eric Adams and New York City Department of City Planning (DCP) Director and City Planning Commission (CPC)

Plan Includes $235 Million in Community Investments, Infrastructure Upgrades, and Open Space

New Housing Will Include Approximately 1,900 Income-Restricted Affordable Units

User stories

Picture yourself in the shoes of one of these New Yorkers below:

Helping your immigrant parents to manage SNAP benefits online, but the steps are confusing, filled with jargon, and sprawling

Visually impaired and trying to find a community event, but your screen reader is stuck in a carousel reading Eric Adam's "accomplishments"

A parent checking for school closures during a winter storm, but the site search isn't prioritizing the right pages

Top pain points

Unclear user flows
Services were submerged under layers of pages because they were designed to reflect the siloes of service owners, punting users around the site and adding unnecessary steps in their journey.

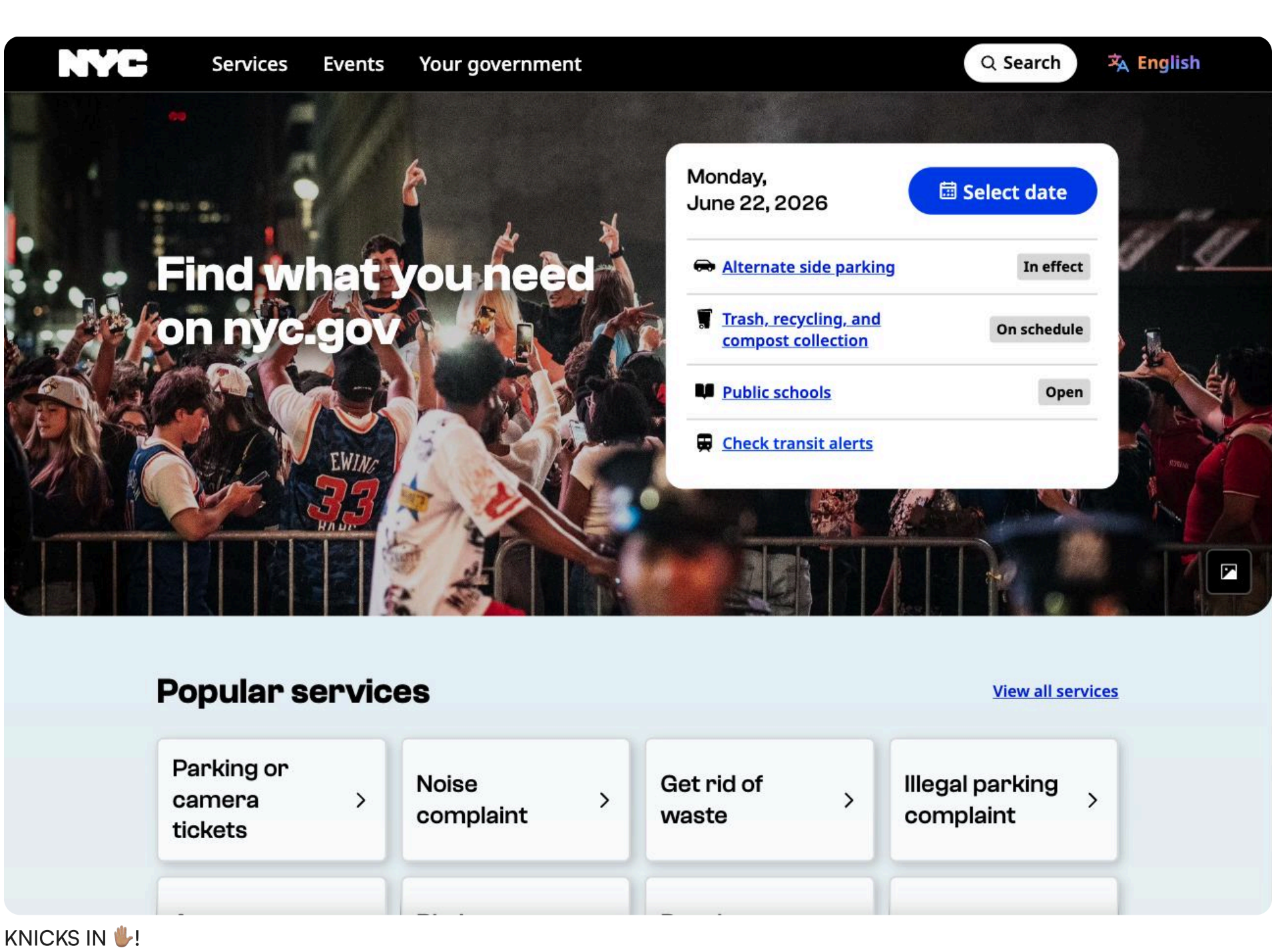
Dead-end pages
Even when users found the right page, it explained a topic without telling them what to do next or where to go, so they read, stalled, and gave up.

Hard to use
The average site performance score on mobile was **25/100** with many components failing WCAG standards. Most users prefer mobile viewport, and even the top 10 pages on mobile scored 53/100.

Org-chart centered menus
The menu was named for the government, not the task. Navigation labels read like an org chart, so a New Yorker who just wanted to pay a ticket had to first guess which agency owned their problem.

OUTCOMES

The redesign helps New Yorkers find, follow through, and finish their tasks.


NYC
Services
Events
Your government
Search
English
Find what you need on nyc.gov
Monday, June 22, 2026
Select date
Alternate side parking
In effect
Trash, recycling, and compost collection
On schedule
Public schools
Open
Check transit alerts
Popular services
View all services
Parking or camera tickets
Noise complaint
Get rid of waste
Illegal parking complaint

KNICKS IN ✋🏽!

Decreased 311 call center calls for services we redesigned
↓ **48%** parking ticket calls
↓ **32%** rent increase calls

13 points in Improved customer satisfaction.
CSAT surveys reported positive feedback related to the navigability, the search experience, translation, and more.

100% accessible
All redesigned pages are **100% WCAG 2.2 accessible**, focused on making in-page navigation, links, and content working for keyboard and low-vision users.

A repeatable model for services
The Guide-page pattern and global navigation component are rolling out across nyc.gov, so every agency can make services easier to find and complete, the same way.

PROCESS

I was responsible for answering 2 questions:

1. Helping people find what they need ↓
   What are most New Yorkers doing on nyc.gov?
2. Helping people finish the task ↓
   How are New Yorkers completing their tasks on the site?

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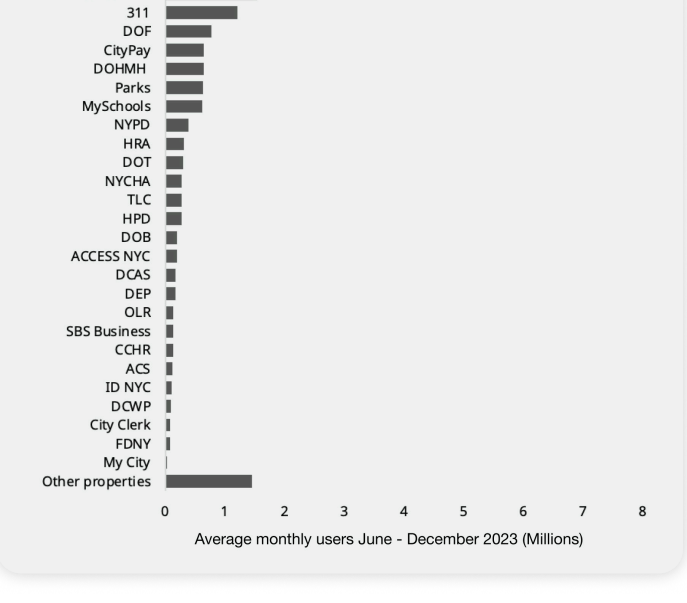
1. Helping people find what they need

GA4 data revealed the handful of tasks most New Yorkers come to do.

Before designing anything, we needed to know where people were actually going. The data pointed us to the Department of Education, but they were on a different tech stack and infrastructure and did not have capacity for collaboration.

So in order to move quickly on deciding which top services to feature on the homepage, we went with the next top action: paying a parking ticket. Additional actions included noise complaints, trash and recycling questions, birth certificates, managing SNAP benefits, and others.

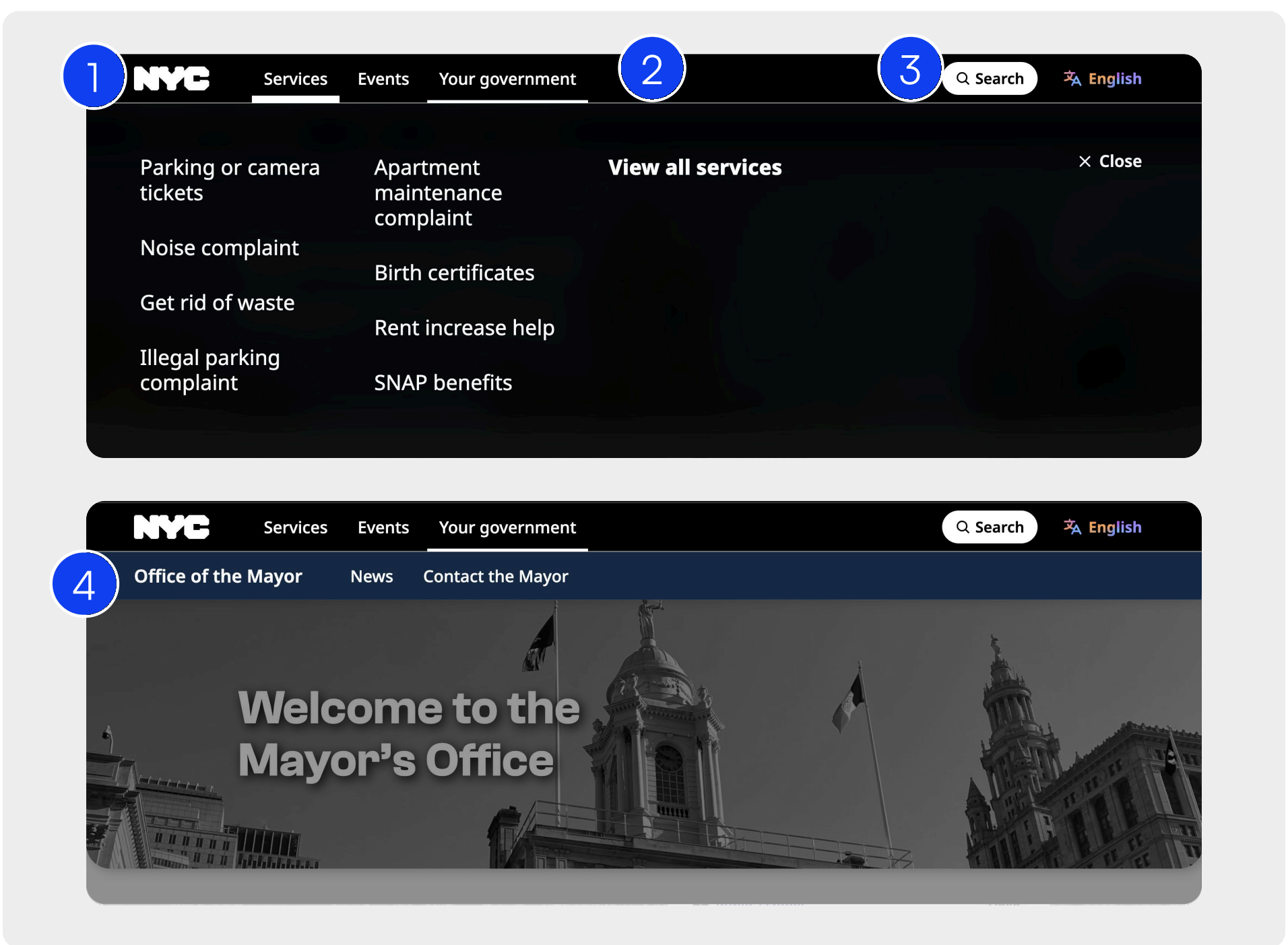


I designed a global navigation component to help users find services faster across 100+ agency sites

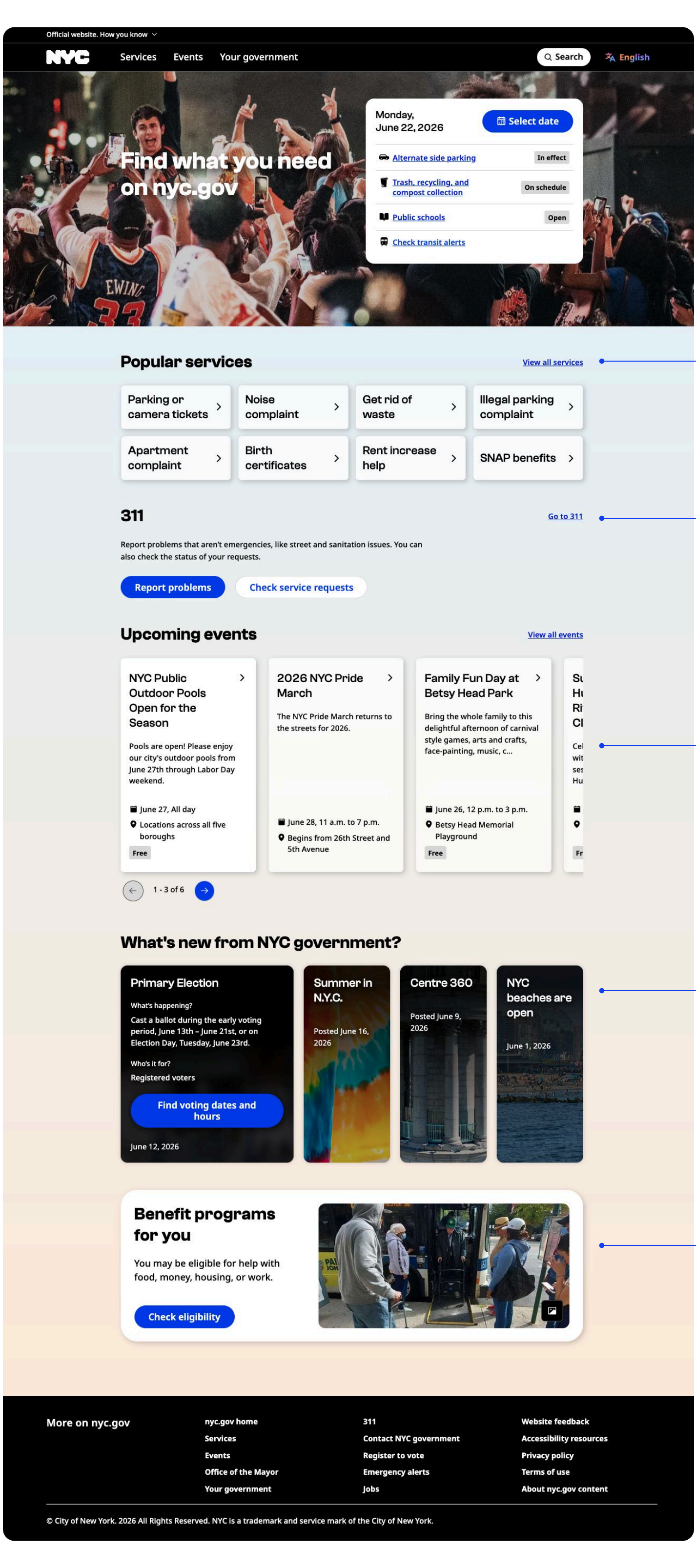
The old navigation mirrored government bureaucracy: no clear hierarchy, no clear path. Users would loop endlessly, starting at the homepage, landing on the wrong page, and struggling to find their way back.

We restructured the information architecture around what users actually look for, using research insights and site analytics. I designed the navigation component, translating that strategy into four decisions:

1. **NYC logo as home base**: Links to the homepage, giving users a consistent anchor across the site.
2. **Service-first menu**: Popular services are surfaced in the global header and regularly updated, reachable from anywhere on nyc.gov.
3. **Prominent search**: Visually highlighted and improved on the backend.
4. **Clear brand hierarchy**: Agency headers sit below the global bar with a preset accessible color for secondary brand expression, so users always know where they are relative to nyc.gov.


1
NYC
Services
Events
Your government
2
3
Search
English
Parking or camera tickets
Noise complaint
Get rid of waste
Illegal parking complaint
Apartment maintenance complaint
Birth certificates
Rent increase help
SNAP benefits
View all services
Close
4
Office of the Mayor
News
Contact the Mayor
Welcome to the Mayor's Office

The homepage became the fastest path to the city's most common tasks.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Get rid of waste
Illegal parking complaint
Apartment complaint
Birth certificates
Rent increase help
SNAP benefits
311
Go to 311
Report problems
Check service requests
Upcoming events
View all events
NYC Public Outdoor Pools Open for the Season
2026 NYC Pride March
Family Fun Day at Betsy Head Park
1 - 3 of 6
What's new from NYC government?
Primary Election
Find voting dates and hours
Summer in N.Y.C.
Centre 360
NYC beaches are open
Benefit programs for you
Check eligibility
More on nyc.gov

Report problems that aren't emergencies, like street and sanitation issues. You can also check the status of your requests.

You may be eligible for help with food, money, housing, or work.

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Popular services was first to direct most users to the services with the highest traffic.

311 is one of the top destinations on nyc.gov. It's the front door for New Yorkers who lack digital access or prefer phone and in-person help, and it operates in many languages.

Many New Yorkers also come to nyc.gov to look for free events hosted by government agencies and community-based organizations. Surfacing events also keeps the site current and gives users a reason to come back.

Seasonal and featured initiatives rotate through this section to match program time windows and press releases

Promotional content to take users to the AccessNYC social benefits application

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2. Helping people finish the task

We restructured the site to make popular services easy to find, follow, and finish, beginning with the most common task: paying a parking ticket.

Paying a parking ticket was our **most popular task**, and **one of its most broken**. The flow mirrored government structure instead of a simple checkout, and missteps could mean additional penalties. It was so convoluted that private companies (WinIt and Pay NYC Fines) built profitable workarounds, charging New Yorkers for something the city should offer free. **This wasn't just a usability problem. It was an equity one.**

After a basic Google search to pay a ticket, users could **arrive at 7 different city starting-points**. This meant there was no single recommended path for users.

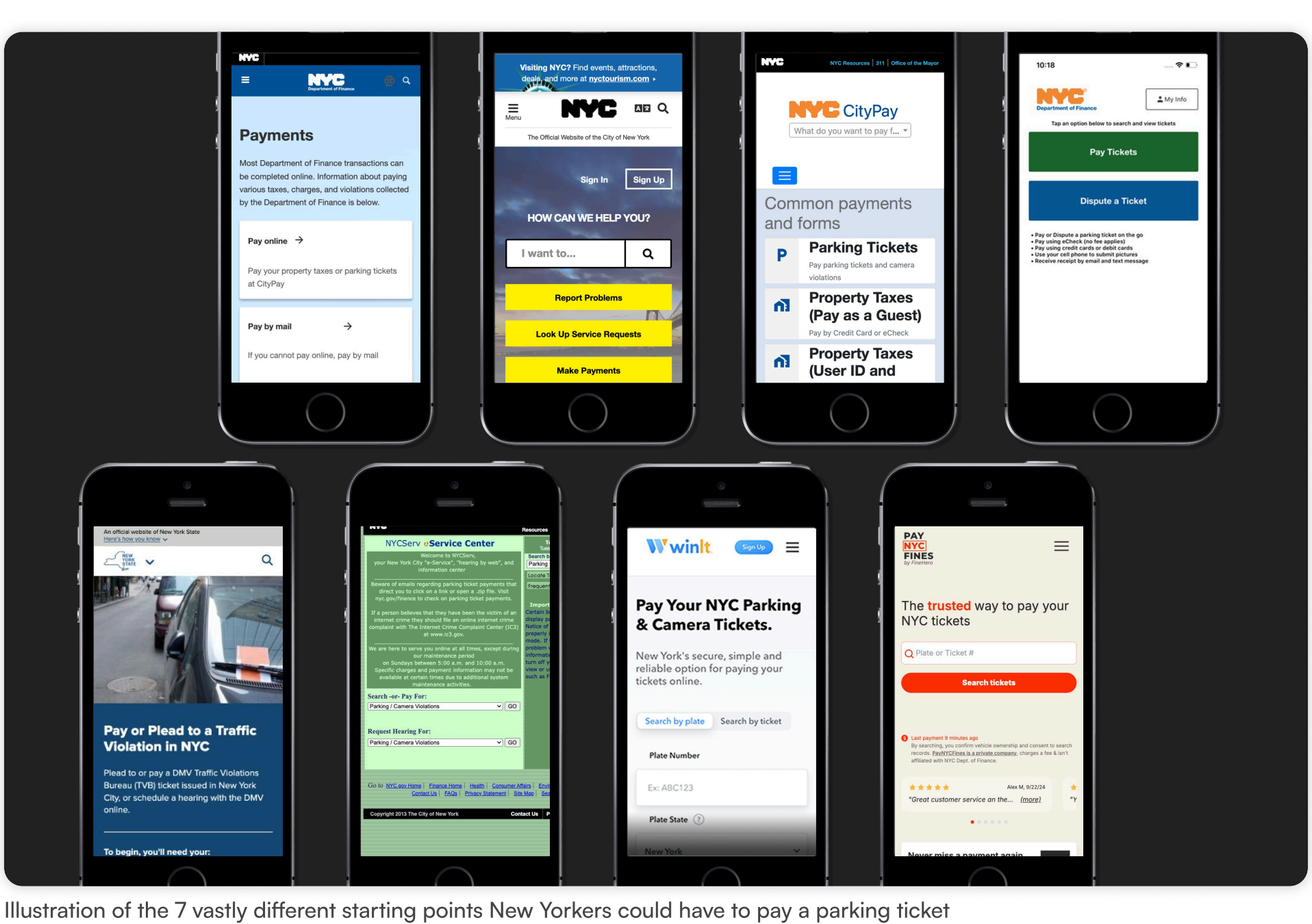
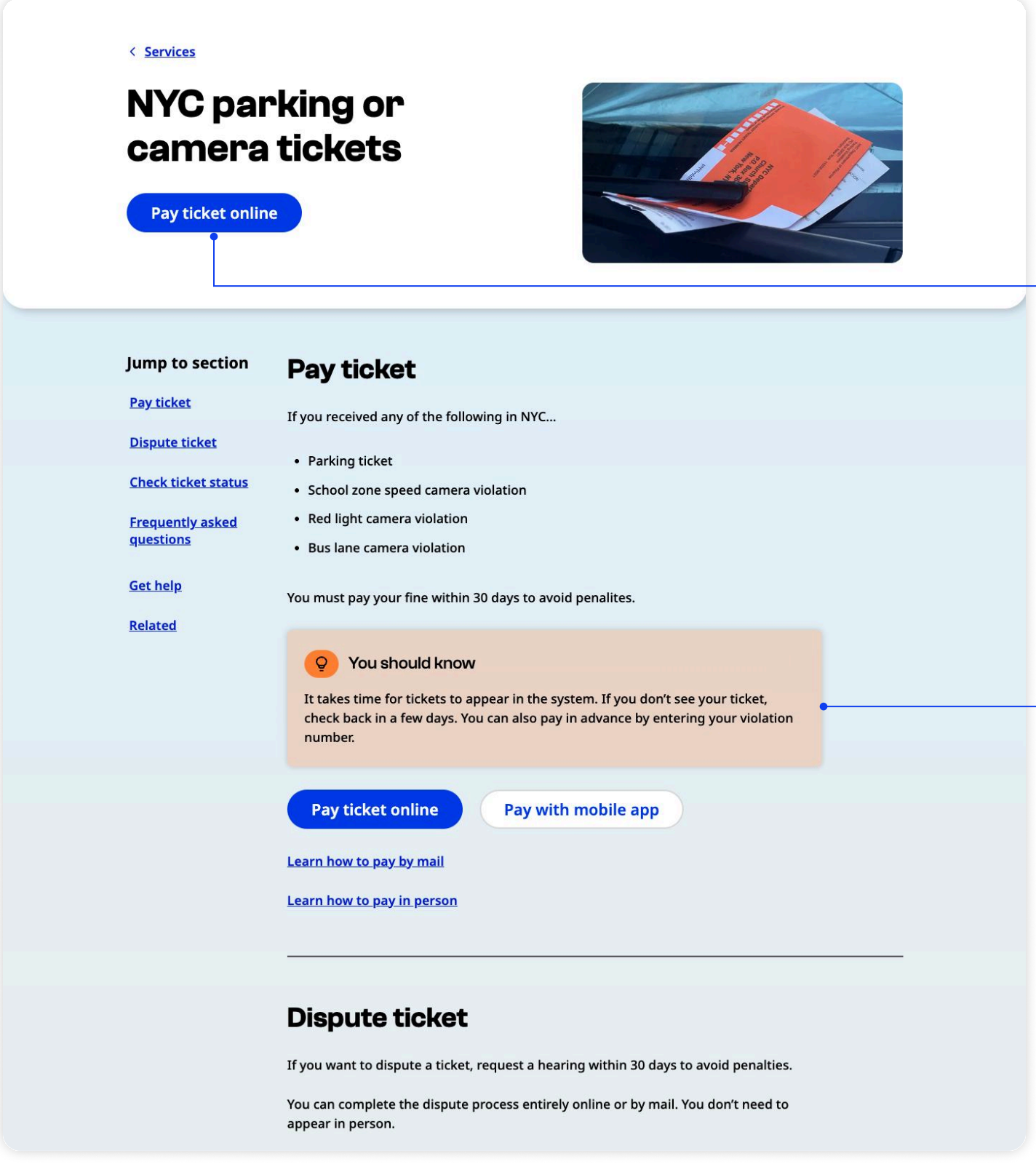

Payments
HOW CAN WE HELP YOU?
Report Problems
Look Up Service Requests
Make Payments
CityPay
Common payments and forms
Parking Tickets
Property Taxes (Pay as a Guest)
Pay Tickets
Dispute a Ticket
Pay or Plead to a Traffic Violation in NYC
NYCServ Service Center
winIt
Pay Your NYC Parking & Camera Tickets.
PAY NYC FINES
The trusted way to pay your NYC tickets
Search tickets

Illustration of the 7 vastly different starting points New Yorkers could have to pay a parking ticket

I designed the first "Guide" page that cut 311 call volume by 48%.

Agency sites on nyc.gov prioritize documenting every option a user could take, rather than the best one. Guides flip that approach: each page sets expectations, surfaces the right information, and points users to a clear next step.

I designed the first Guide page, structuring content and layout so users could scan for what applies to them, understand what's required, and act without second-guessing. That clarity paid off in its first quarter after launch with a drop in 311 calls.


‹ Services
NYC parking or camera tickets
Pay ticket online
Jump to section
Pay ticket
Dispute ticket
Check ticket status
Frequently asked questions
Get help
Related
You should know
Pay ticket online
Pay with mobile app
Learn how to pay by mail
Learn how to pay in person

Pay ticket

If you received any of the following in NYC...

- Parking ticket
- School zone speed camera violation
- Red light camera violation
- Bus lane camera violation

You must pay your fine within 30 days to avoid penalties.

It takes time for tickets to appear in the system. If you don't see your ticket, check back in a few days. You can also pay in advance by entering your violation number.

Dispute ticket

If you want to dispute a ticket, request a hearing within 30 days to avoid penalties.

You can complete the dispute process entirely online or by mail. You don't need to appear in person.

The correct and best payment path is the top call-to-action

Surfaced critical process details that had previously been buried

I led the design of a city-wide design system so these wins could scale to every agency.

nyc.gov spans hundreds of sites and thousands of pages. The work we'd done so far was meaningful, but without a shared design infrastructure, every agency would keep building inconsistently, and the improvements wouldn't hold.

The design system grows with research into end-to-end user journeys and each redesigned service. I go in-depth on my role in the creation of the design system in the case study below:

NYC
Digital Design System

NYC Design System
First design system for NYC government capable of scaling with multitudes of different service and product contexts. Currently in city-wide adoption and scaling.

OUTCOMES

Real results for real New Yorkers.

13 points in Improved customer satisfaction.
CSAT surveys reported positive feedback related to the navigability, cleanliness of the new visual design, the search experience, and more.

Decreased 311 call center calls for services we redesigned
↓ **41%** parking ticket calls
↓ **28%** rent increase calls

Increased accessibility
All redesigned pages are **100% accessible**. New content style guide sets content strategy north star across government to write in plain language.

Adoption and rollout
Wrote and implemented a city-wide policy for all government agencies to **adopt the design system**. Currently scaling rollout with multiple agencies.

RELATED PROJECTS

Bus pole RTPI design
Designed a new scalable, accessible real-time passenger information (RTPI) system for bus poles that clearly communicates bus arrivals and feels like a cohesive part of NYC's transit network.

Bus shelter RTPI design
Designed a clear and concise UI system and experience for bus shelters that are accessible and familiar to all New Yorkers.